

Ἀστράμψυχος ὁ μάγος

Astrampsychnus the Magician and the Oracles

eul_aid: ptg

Period: *Ῥωμαϊκή* [Roman](#)
Dialect: *Κοινή* [Koine](#)
Domain: *Ἐπιστήμη* [Science](#)
Format: *Πραγματεία* Treatise

Astrampsychnus the Magician is a pseudonymous figure of the 2nd century CE to whom works of divination and magic were attributed. He is presented as either a Persian magus or an Egyptian sage, a literary construct designed to lend authority to the texts ascribed to him. His name, suggesting astral or mystical phenomena, and his Persian association reflect the Greco-Roman view of Eastern occult expertise.

The primary works attributed to him are The Oracles of Astrampsychnus, a popular numerical lot-oracle for personal questions surviving in Greek manuscripts, and The Oneirocriticon of Astrampsychnus, a dream-interpretation manual sometimes associated with him. His significance lies in the reception of his attributed texts. The Oracles of Astrampsychnus was a widely used divinatory tool, providing valuable evidence for non-elite beliefs and popular ritual practice in the Roman Empire.

As a pseudonym, "Astrampsychnus" functioned as an authoritative brand, similar to Hermes Trismegistus, conferring ancient wisdom upon works of magic and divination.

Works (2)

- [Χρησμοί · Oracles \(Long Recension\)](#) · 91 passages
- [Χρησμοί · Oracles \(Short Recension\)](#) · 64 passages